

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Abdul Khougani

Address: 8 Kenilworth Terrace York Road Cheam SM2 6HD

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I support planning application DM2025/01591 wholeheartedly. The area needs more community infrastructure and this proposal delivers it on a site that would otherwise continue to sit empty.

This facility will generate far less car traffic than its attendance numbers might suggest. The travel data shows the vast majority of users walk or car-share. The cycle storage provided in the application supports sustainable alternatives further.

The ambulance station had 24-hour operations with emergency vehicle movements at all times of day and night. By any reasonable comparison, this is a better neighbour. The proposed community hub will operate within set hours and generate far less noise and traffic.

I would also note that this is a well-evidenced application that meets all the relevant policy tests. I am confident the Council will give it a fair and objective assessment based on the material planning considerations.

On this point, while the faith provision addresses a specific need in the Muslim community, the community hub is for everyone. The range of activities proposed, from education to wellbeing to social events, means this facility will benefit the whole neighbourhood.

The submitted noise report confirms that the building fabric will contain sound effectively. This meets the Local Authority's criteria. Even at the busiest time, with amplified speech during Friday prayers, the noise reaching neighbouring properties is predicted to be below ambient background

levels.

I wholeheartedly support this application and ask the Council to grant planning permission. This facility is needed and will be welcomed.